

playing online against or with other people. Just having an online element in games, being connected, being able to share, compare, compete, all of these things can be considered multiplayer and can enhance a gaming experience. Most of the games on social media make use of this sharing and comparing format of multiplayer, even games like say the very popular 'Trials' bike game, had an active leaderboard and the ability to share, compare, and compete with friends. You could even create custom courses and challenge each other. This multiplayer aspect gave the game much more longevity than if it were a single player game which would be over and done with once the campaign was finished. Add to that the prospect of adding content over time and free content in the future, which makes having an online element all the more important. But that's not what we're majorly concerned with here, our concern is whether or not the advent of multiplayer signals the death of single player entirely.

When single player goes multiplayer

As we mentioned, a lot of single player games have been adding a multiplayer element to remain relevant. This can have both positive and negative effects. Making a multiplayer mode for a primarily single player game might seem like an easy task on paper to the clueless, which is why we're calling them clueless. If the team that works on the single player aspect has to focus on multiplayer as well, you can be damn sure that the single player experience will suffer as a result, and you might get a sub par multiplayer experience as well. On the other hand, if you have a different team working on the multiplayer aspect then while it may be more functional and mechanically sound, it'll feel disconnected and irrelevant to the single player story. So forcing multiplayer upon a game is never going to end up with good results. Building a game to incorporate multiplayer from the ground up however, has actually shown positive results, where both the single player and multiplayer experience have been found to be fun.



Left 4 Dead and Gears of War are great examples of such games.

The "next big thing"

The video game industry is very quick to pronounce stuff as the next big thing. And when there's a new "next big thing" it's often thought that the older things are dead and gone. This is far from the truth though. MMOs were the "next big thing" at one point of time, we don't see too many of those around at the moment, just the usual bigwigs like WoW. Then there was a time when social networking games were the big thing, with all the Farmvilles and Candy Crushes. Then of course there were the MOBAs, which one could say are still pretty big considering the following games like League of Legends and Dota 2 have right now. Many developers and publishers are still trying to make games in the MOBA genre with a twist or a new mechanic in them to hook more people like how Smite incorporated the third-person view. The world seems to be shifting towards multiplayer shooters now with Counter Strike: Global Offensive and Overwatch rising in popularity around the world. Won't be long before someone or the other claims that MOBAs are dead or CS:GO is the next MOBA killer. But what we're getting at here is that despite all these solely multiplayer online games being the next best thing, we had titles like Skyrim, Dishon-



oured, Mass Effect, and Dragon Age releasing which were stellar single player games that were hugely successful.

The eSports era

eSports is huge right now, one could say that this is what actually sparked the push for multiplayer. The success that